



Pilgrim Paths

St Mary's, Kington, HR5 3AG



5 miles circular walk

*Including moderately steep climbs.
Or a shorter alternative of approx 3.5 miles
Kington Pilgrim Path from St Mary's Church*

Welcome to the Kington Benefice Pilgrim Paths Project

A pilgrimage is a spiritual journey to a sacred place. From earliest times, people have travelled to the 'thin places' of the world which offer opportunities for reflection and encounter. Pilgrim routes have shaped the landscape and history of this country from medieval times to the present day, as well as playing a major part in the spiritual journeys of many of its inhabitants.

The churches of the Kington Benefice offer you the hospitality of their buildings, which are open daily, and the opportunity to explore the local environment along ancient ways, through outstanding landscapes.

We invite you to make this short pilgrim journey in a spirit of openness to what it might offer, delight in the countryside through which you travel and companionship with those who have travelled this way before and will do so after you.

The reflections in this leaflet are based on the Psalms, 150 ancient poems which form part of the Christian Bible. They deal with the whole range of human experience and contain much wisdom. We hope you find them a useful source of encouragement and support as you journey.

Pilgrim God

*You are our origin and our destination-
Travel with us, we pray, in every
pilgrimage of faith, and every journey
of the heart.*

*Give us the courage to set off,
the nourishment we need to travel well,
and the welcome we long for at our
journey's end.*

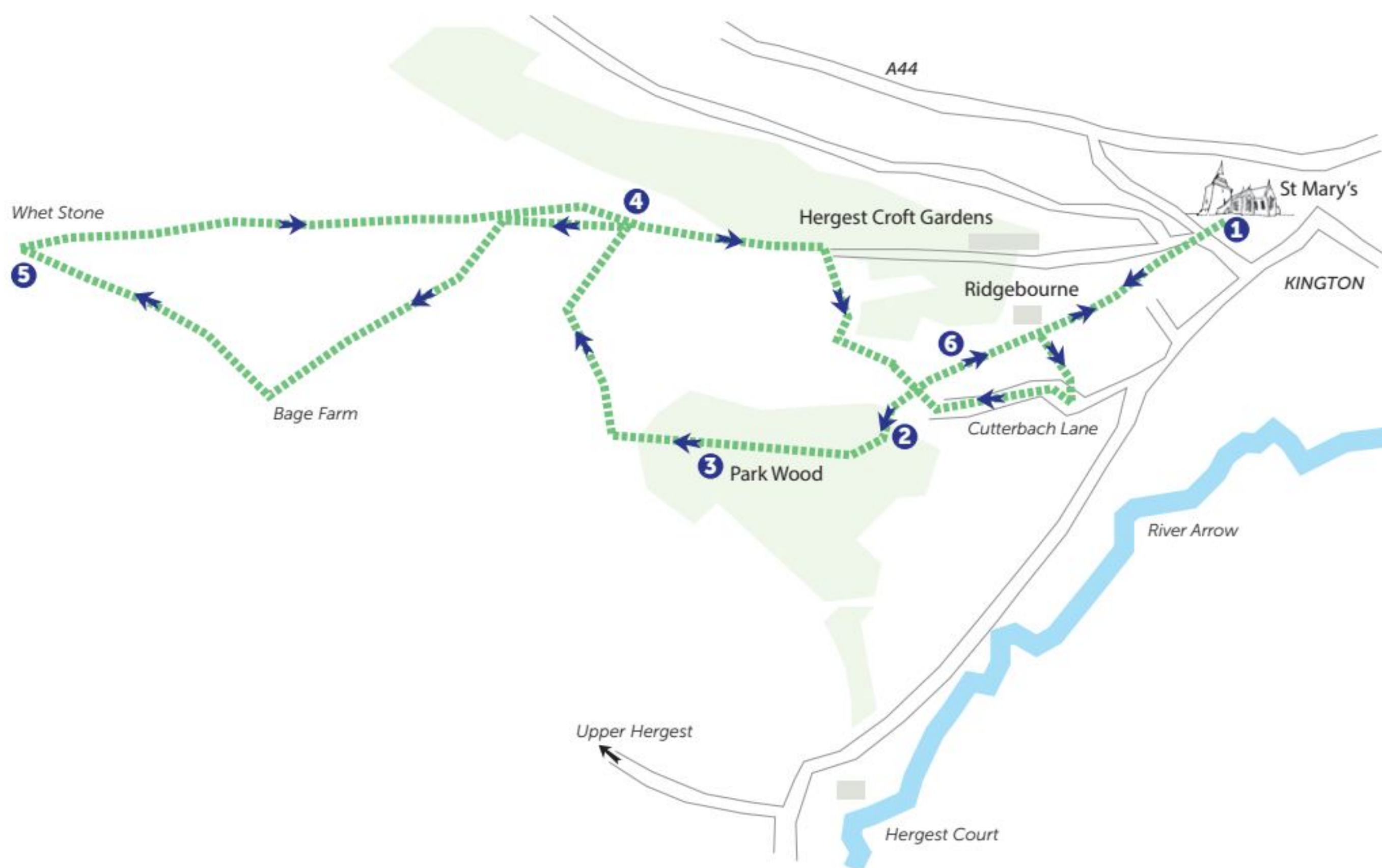
*So may we grow in grace and love of you
And in the service of others,
Through Jesus Christ our Lord,*

Amen.

(Bishop John Pritchard)



Kington Pilgrim Path from St Mary's Church. 5 miles circular walk, including moderately steep climbs. Shorter alternative of approx 3.5 miles



*God of creation and re-creation, bless this journey.
Help me to be mindful of the wonders that surround me.
Help me to journey reflectively,
taking the time to consider my spiritual landscape
as well as the countryside that surrounds me,
and help me to rejoice in both.
Amen*

Look out for the Pilgrim Path
way markers around the walk



Psalm 34

¹ *I will extol the LORD at all times;
his praise will always be on my lips..*

³ *Glorify the LORD with me:
let us exalt his name together.*

1 As you stand in the church porch think of one thing that makes you want to praise God.
Can you share that with someone in your group?

From the church porch turn right down to the lane below. Turn right towards the main road and cross over to Ridgebourne Road (signposted Ridgebourne / Hergest Croft). Continue up the road until the first Public Footpath notice on the left. Go through the 'kissing gate' and follow the path, past Ridgebourne House, crossing the drive through two kissing gates. Continue on until you see a modern wooden house off to the right. Take the footpath to the left down towards a small grey cottage ('Nant-y-Felin'). Go through the gate on Cutterbach Lane and turn right past the cottage.

Follow the lane between some high hedges. Cross a cattle grid and continue straight towards Park Wood. At the entrance to the wood cross another cattle grid. Where the path divides, takes the right fork and follow signs to the Pond. You will pass a footpath sign pointing to the right. You return to this shortly.

2 ⁴ *I sought the Lord, and he answered me; he delivered me from all my fears...*

⁷ *The angel of the Lord encamps around those who fear him, and he delivers them.*

What are the things you fear? What must it feel like to know the protection of God in every situation?

Continue towards the Pond where you might like to stop and admire the landscape. (There is a scenic 'Himalyan' path round the pond, but this is not a right of way. If you would like to follow it please make a donation in the collecting tube that you passed earlier.)

3 ⁸ *Taste and see that the Lord is good; blessed is the one who takes refuge in him.*

⁹ *Fear the Lord, you his holy people, for those who fear him lack nothing.*

¹⁰ *The lions may grow weak and hungry, but those who seek the Lord lack no good thing.*

What taste comes to mind as you read this verse? Do you, or could you, rely on God for every good thing?

Retrace your steps to the footpath sign which directs you left up a slope through the wood. You soon pass an old quarry on the right. Continue upwards for about 300m to the edge of the wood.

Go through the timber farm gate and keep straight ahead for 50m to a metal farm gate.

Turn sharp right onto a track. This marks the start of a permissive path. Follow the track for about 60m and then go through a kissing gate on the left into a large field sloping up the hill. Keep to the path with the hedge on your right. At the top go through another gate and turn to the right, following the hedge. You can see Kington to your right and the Black Mountains beyond. After a short while you pass a yew tree. Continue towards another kissing gate which marks the end of the permissive path.

You will now find yourself on a broad path following Hergest Ridge. This is part of the Offa's Dyke Path. Beyond, you can see Bradnor Hill and Kington Golf Club - the highest golf club in England.

4 ¹¹ *Come, my children, listen to me;
I will teach you the fear of the Lord.*

¹² *Whoever of you loves life
and desires to see many good days,.*

¹³ *keep your tongue from evil
and your lips from telling lies.*

¹⁴ *Turn from evil and do good;
seek peace and pursue it.*

Truth and peace live together. Reflect on the power of your words that can cause trouble or make peace.

*At this point you can choose to follow the longer route up to the top of Hergest Ridge and a plantation of 'Money Puzzle' trees (approx. 3 miles, or 45 minutes walking), or turn right and follow the path back to Ridgebourne Road. If you opt for the shorter route, skip forward to **.*

Follow the broad path up the ridge until you come to the first waymark which directs you diagonally left for about 750m. When you reach a small farm called 'Bage' turn right at the footpath sign and follow the open path to the top of the ridge. Soon the clump of 'Monkey Puzzle' trees (Araucaria Araucana - Chilean Pine) will come into sight. You cross an old race course exactly 1 mile round.

5 ¹⁵ *The eyes of the Lord are on the righteous, and his ears are attentive to their cry...*

¹⁷ *The righteous cry out, and the Lord hears them; he delivers them from all their troubles.*

¹⁸ *The Lord is close to the broken-hearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit*

As you stand under the open skies and see the distant hills you might feel very small and insignificant but these words remind us that God is close. He hears us, he sees our troubles, and he stands by us. How does that make you feel?

Now the path is downhill all the way back. Follow the main path back to the end of the permissive path.

***Continue down the hill to a gate at the top of Ridgebourne Road. Soon after the 'Welcome to Kington' sign take the bridleway to the right and go through Haywards Farm. (Remember to shut the gates, and keep any dogs on leads.) Go through the farmyard and follow the track round to the right and then the left. Pass Hill Farm on your left, and soon you will come to a crossing on the track. Take the footpath through the gate on the left. This bends round to the right back towards Ridgebourne.*

6 ¹⁹ *The righteous person may have many troubles, but the Lord delivers him from them all;*

²⁰ *he protects all his bones, not one of them will be broken...*

²² *The Lord will rescue his servants; no one who takes refuge in him will be condemned.*

As you make your way home reflect on the different landscapes you have seen: which are you particularly drawn to? Do you prefer to set out or to come home? What helps to make you feel secure?

You will see Hergest Croft in the distance to your left. Continue past the house back to Ridgebourne Road. Turn right and retrace your steps back to the church.

Pilgrim Paths

Kington Benefice

Pilgrim Paths across the Benefice

The circular walks include walking on local roads, bridleways and footpaths through woods and field. There are some stiles and some moderate ascents. You may encounter sheep, cattle or horses.

Countryside code : Respect, Protect, Enjoy!

Respect other people

- *Consider the local community and other people enjoying the outdoors*
- *Leave gates and property as you find them and follow paths unless wider access is available*

Protect the natural environment

- *Leave no trace of your visit and take your litter home*
- *Keep dogs under effective control*

Enjoy the outdoors

- *Plan ahead and be prepared*
- *Follow advice and local signs.*

St Mary's Kington, is part of the Sanctuary Network

<https://www.britishpilgrimage.org/sanctuary-network>



Kington Benefice

www.kingtonparishes.org.uk